

SOP-LV-030 — Occupied-Space Conduct Policy

Professional Conduct in Schools and Other Occupied Public Buildings

SOP NUMBER	SOP-LV-030
TITLE	Occupied-Space Conduct Policy
EFFECTIVE DATE	July 25, 2026
REVISION	1.0
APPLIES TO	All Apex field technicians — Ontario & Manitoba
CATEGORY	Personal Safety & Conduct

1. Purpose

This procedure sets the standard of conduct expected of Apex technicians working in occupied buildings — particularly K-12 schools — while students, staff, or the public are present. It exists to protect both the people in these buildings and Apex technicians themselves from misunderstandings.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all Apex technicians performing work in any occupied institutional or public building, with particular emphasis on school sites. It supplements the occupied-space items already confirmed on the Jobsite Safety Checklist (SOP-LV-003).

3. Sign-In and Identification

- Sign in at the front office (or designated point) on every visit, without exception, even for a five-minute callback.
- Wear Apex identification visibly at all times while on site.

4. Interacting with Students and Staff

- Keep interactions brief and professional. You are there to do a job, not to supervise or entertain.
- Never be alone with a student in a closed room. If your work requires access to an occupied classroom, coordinate with school staff rather than working solo among students.
- Redirect any student questions or requests to a teacher or staff member — it is never a technician's role to instruct, discipline, or supervise a student.

5. Photography and Documentation

Photos taken for work documentation (per SOP-LV-003 and incident reporting) must be framed to exclude students, staff, and any personally identifiable material — photograph the equipment or hazard itself, not the people around it.

SOP-LV-030 — Occupied-Space Conduct Policy

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6. Restricted Areas and Quiet Hours

Follow the occupied-space protocols confirmed with the site contact at arrival, per SOP-LV-003 — quiet hours, restricted zones, and any areas that are off-limits while students or staff are present.

7. Escalating an Uncomfortable Situation

If any interaction feels wrong — with a student, staff member, or member of the public — leave the immediate area and notify the site contact and your supervisor right away. Do not wait to see if it resolves itself.

8. Background Screening

Technicians assigned to school sites maintain current vulnerable sector screening as required by the relevant school board, renewed on the schedule set by Apex policy. Confirm your screening is current with your supervisor before accepting a school assignment.

9. Prohibited Practices

Never agree to be alone with a student, regardless of who asks.

If a staff member or the situation puts you in a position of being alone with a student, disengage and involve school staff immediately — this protects the student and you.

- Never use a personal phone for non-work purposes while in a student-occupied area.
- Never discuss Apex, client, or other job details with students or unauthorized staff.

10. Regulatory References

- Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act, ss. 25–26 — general duty provisions
- Applicable school board contractor and visitor policies (site-specific — confirm with site contact)
- Manitoba Workplace Safety and Health Act, C.C.S.M. c. W210 — general duty provisions

11. Related Apex Documents

- SOP-LV-003 — Ontario Jobsite Health & Safety Checklist
- SOP-LV-028 — Workplace Violence Prevention & De-escalation

12. Revision History

Rev.	Date	Description	Approved By
1.0	Jul 25, 2026	Initial release	P. Cimini

This document is proprietary to Apex and is intended for internal use by Apex technicians and supervisors. Effective date: July 25, 2026.